

Interview with Margot

As part of our research, we wanted to get into the field and talk to people, who know more about dementia than we do.

So, on sunday evening (the 13th of October 2024) we sat together with Margot, and had a great conversation. Margot has dementia, but does not let that take away her happiness.



Nicolas Weber (Left), Margot (Middle), and Tim Ruland (Right)

What does she do?

Margot has always been a rather occupied person. She proudly told us about working at the Oktoberfest, in her past. Today she is helping at an elderly home.

Who takes care of her?

Now that she had gotten older, she also needs to be assisted in every day life. A few times per week her son comes to visit, and take care of her. But as he does not have the time to do all the work, every day caregivers come around to help her.

Margot is happy with the people she is surrounded by. But finding enough caregivers is tough. Caregiving services do not nearly have sufficient people in their staff.

Technology Margot uses:

Margot has a mobile phone. Not a smart phone, but one of those old phones, with haptic buttons, which you can use to make phone calls. She told us that, she only uses it, when something important comes up, although she does like talking on the phone for quite some time. She does not use a smart phone, as it would be hard for her to learn something new.

Margot owns a television, which is getting more and more difficult for her to use. All the buttons and functions are simply too much for her to handle now. Her son told us, a remote with only three buttons would be fitting for her.

When an accident occurs, Margot has the option to make an emergency call just by pressing one button, which is located on a kind of bracelet on her wrist. We asked her what she does when she has an accident, and she forgot that she has the bracelet.

What we learned about dementia:

Margot knows a lot about her past, very similar to people without dementia. For example, she still gets home from the elderly home by herself, without any trouble.

She has always been a more tidy and clean person; So, she likes cleaning the apartment. But she seems to forget small steps, like getting rid of the towels she uses to clean.v